

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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BEING PLANTED REMAINING PLANTED

John 12:23-24

Jesus was that seed

Recently in one of my reflections we looked at John 12:23-26 and presented what the message of that story spoke about himself.

However, there is another aspect of verses 23 & 24 in this passage that we will be looking at in this reflection.

It is the words of Jesus that he spoke about himself and their **significance** to every believer.

John 12:23-24

23 Jesus replied that the time had come for him to return to his glory in heaven, and that **"I must fall and die like a kernel of wheat that falls into the furrows of the earth. Unless I die I will be alone—a single seed. But my death will produce many new wheat kernels—a plentiful harvest of new lives.** TLB

John 12:24 Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone: **but if it die**, it bringeth forth much fruit. KJV



- ▲ Here Jesus is speaking about himself as God's only Son and that through being planted in this earth and dying would produce many 'sons and daughters.'
- ▲ **Jesus was that seed** that **fell** down into the ground (**this world**) and **died** and this act produced a harvest of many new fruits (lives).
- ▲ And every believer is called upon to **follow Christ's example, and we can better do that by taking note of the individual steps** that he outlined **for himself** for this event to happen.
- ▲ And it is those same steps/principles that we need to **identify** and **apply** to our lives.
- ▲ It has been this way for all believers throughout the ages and **how much more is it needed today in our generation?**
- ▲ *John 12:24* I tell you the truth, **unless** a kernel of wheat is **planted** in the soil and dies, it remains alone. But its death will produce many new kernels—a plentiful harvest of new lives. NLT

Identifying and applying those steps or principles **for every believer.**

Principle one

EXCEPT or UNLESS

- This means that it is **CONDITIONAL** on something **FIRST** taking place. Some act must **precede** for any resulting actions to take place.
- **IF** the corn of wheat (Jesus) and the believer do not **FALL** into the earth/world), then there will be no resulting fruit.

Principle two

FALLING

The direction is defined - **DOWNWARDS**

- According to the dictionary, **falling** means moving from a higher to a lower level, typically rapidly and **without control**.
- Without control, suggests that the person falling down is not in control or the terms and conditions of that action.

- The disciple must be prepared to trust that God would take care of their falling.
- **LOCATION** – falling INTO the earth – INTO this world.

Principle three

NOT ACCIDENTAL

- This falling down was NOT ACCIDENTAL (like an accident or misfortune) – NO
- It was a DELIBERATE ACTION that resulted from a DELIBERATE CHOICE to submit to a higher will than ours.
- This was NO **spontaneous**, unplanned, unprepared action but one that had been contemplated and thoroughly thought through prior to a definite decision being made.

Principle four

PLANTED

This falling into the earth includes the concept of BEING **PLANTED**.

*John 12:24 I tell you the truth, unless a kernel of wheat is **planted** in the soil and dies, it remains alone. But its death will produce many new kernels—a plentiful harvest of new lives. NLT*

*John 12:24 I can guarantee this truth: A single grain of wheat doesn't produce anything unless it is **planted** in the ground and dies. If it dies, it will produce a lot of grain. GOD'S WORD*

- **PLANTED** indicates **PERMANENCY** – not transitory (temporary).
- IT MEANS **DYING/DEATH**.
- **Permanency** is a concept that describes the state of being lasting or enduring.
- Jesus' death meant being **planted in his father's will** and remaining faithful and committed in that position until all had been accomplished.
- **DYING** is a present tense process, but **DEATH** is a past tense accomplished act.

DEATH - someone and something must **DIE**.

- ★ It could be our will, plans, desires and aspirations that **must die**
- ★ **DEATH** in this instance is not **negative** but a positive opportunity.
- ★ To show our love for God more and less of ourselves.
- ★ It's about multiplying and reproducing ourselves from being a single seed to producing many new seeds/lives.

Remaining buried

- ★ It's about remaining buried for sufficient time that our lives will germinate/spring into life and produce much new fruit/lives.

Resurrection

- ★ It's about resurrection, BUT there must be **death** before there can be a **Resurrection**.

PLANTED

- ★ Being **planted** clearly indicates a definite intention by THE SOWER that the seed SOWN should **REMAIN WHERE** it is sown UNTIL it has fulfilled its proper time to germinate and burst into life.

APPLICATION FOR US

- Therefore, BEING **PLANTED** DEFINITELY REQUIRES REMAINING WHERE YOU HAVE BEEN SOWN.
- THAT IS REMAINING FAITHFUL and COMMITTED TO YOUR ASSIGNED **LOCATION** AND **RESPONSIBILITIES** that have been entrusted to you.
- This will require perseverance and vigilance and standing firm in the face of the many changing circumstances, challenges, criticisms, and disappointments with people's responses.
- BUT REMAINING WHERE PLANTED gives the disciple a great sense of confidence and well-being in knowing that God will cause the Seed sown to reproduce itself.

To the believer

- Let us be willing to accept God's desire for us that we be planted in his work and in his field – wherever that might be and have a preparedness to die to our self-centered plans and aspirations and a willingness to remain planted until trust and hope produce reality.

Amen Ps Barry